ALAGAPPA UNIVERSITY

(Accredited with "A+" Grade by NAAC (CGPA:3.64) in the Third Cycle & Graded as Category-I University and Granted Autonomy by MHRD-UGC)

KARAIKUDI – 630 003

Date: 12.11.2019

The Department of Library and Information Science, Alagappa University, Karaikudi, organised a one-day long programme to celebrate the "World Literacy Day" at the Convocation Auditorium of the University on 11.11.2019.

In his inaugural address Vice-Chancellor Prof. N. Rajendran emphasized the importance of reading not only subject books but also general books, novels, fiction etc., for widening one's own horizon of knowledge. While quoting historical evidences, he observed, that the history of most countries have been written by citizens of the respective countries. To understand our own history, we need to read the books written by Europeans. This is so because the Scholars in India, though wrote more secular and non secular literature and poems, have not written the history of their own regions and their own country. Kautilya is in fact, as good as Socrates, Plato and Aristotle. However, legal and political aspects are found more in European writings than in Indian writings.

Without literacy, literature could not have been developed to such extent in India. So, ancient India was very rich in literature owing to literacy. However the historical evidences are absent to show the earlier developments. The recent Keeladi archaeological excavations have given some strong evidences to prove that the Tamils were literates even 2500 years ago.

In spite of all developments, still there are many illiterates in the world. Serious and continuous steps have to be taken to improve literacy among the peoples of the world. Emphasising the importance of literacy and languages, the UNESCO has announced the main theme of this year's World Literacy Day as "Multilingualism" . All languages have to be given equal importance so as to develop them to be useful instruments for the advancement of the nation. The only way to quench the intellectual hunger is to read more and more and particularly history, he observed.

Mr.J.D.Cruise and Mr.Akara Mudhalvan, distinguished writers, were the guest speakers in the programme. They stressed the need for inculcating the reading habits among the students and general public. Unless we read, we cannot contribute substantially to the development of our society, they observed.

In order to stimulate the reading habits among the teachers, research scholars and students, three best users of University Library were identified and they were awarded with prizes and certificates.

The coordinator of the programme and Head of the Department of Library and Information Science Dr.S.Thanuskodi, welcomed the gathering, Dr. KR.Murugan, Dean, Faculty of Arts, offered felicitations. Dr.Jayashankar, Assistant Professor, Dept. of Library and Informatin Science, proposed a vote of thanks.

Students, research scholars and faculty members of various Departments participated in large numbers in the programme.

Prof.H.Gurumallesh Prabu

REGISTRAR